PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
Connect • Serve • Change Lives

Partners of the Americas Competency Modeling Framework

July 12, 2023

Brighter Strategies, LLC

www.brighterstrategies.com

Brighter Strategies
Better process Brighter results

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

What is competency modeling and why are we doing this?

A competency model has multiple applications that fuel an organization's productivity and effectiveness:

Performance Management

- Clarifying performance expectations
- Improving the quality of feedback

Training and Career Development

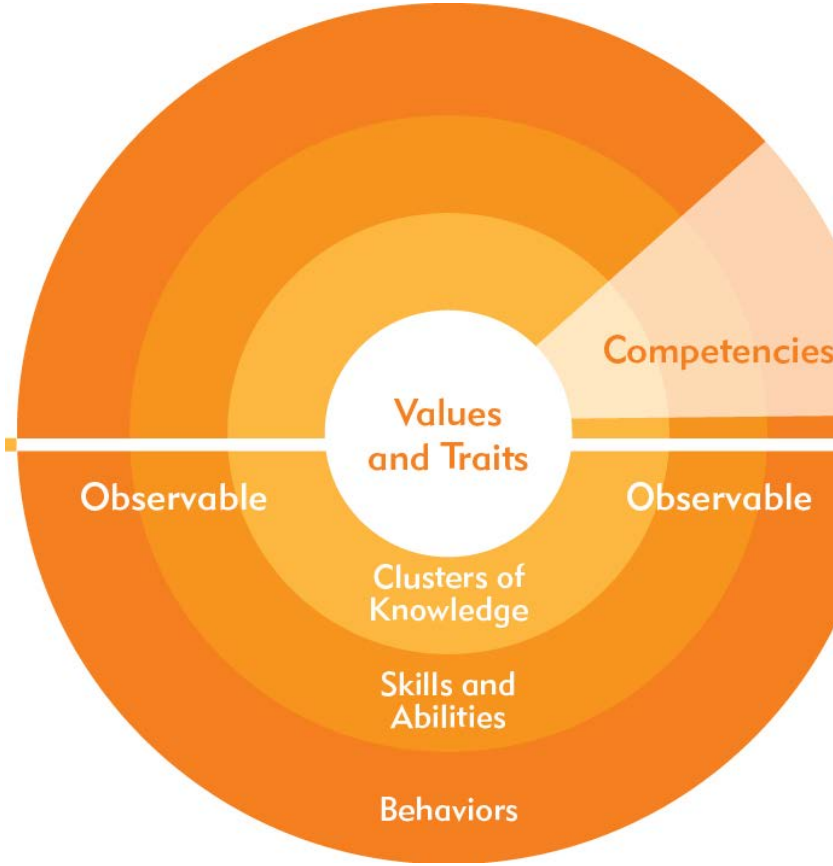
- Developing targeted learning solutions (workshops, coaching, mentoring, etc.)
- Promotions/upward mobility (promotion criteria)

Workforce Planning

- Translating organizational demands into concrete talent needs
- Interviewing talent through behavior-based interviewing techniques

Compensation/Pay-for-Performance

- Combining achievement of results (tangible elements) and competencies (observed behavior)



Brighter Strategies
Better process Brighter results

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Technical vs. Behavioral Competencies

Behavioral Competencies are a set of behaviors described in observable and measurable terms that make employees particularly effective in their work when applied in appropriate situations. Behavioral Competency Models may be designed to describe common or "core" behaviors that apply to employees throughout an organization or may be more narrowly defined to reflect behaviors unique to a specific job family.

- Interpersonal Skills
- Managing Work
- Delegation
- Teamwork

Technical Competencies are underlying knowledge and skills, described in observable and measurable terms necessary for employees to perform a particular type or level of work activity. Technical Competencies typically reflect a career-long experience in a specific field or organization.

- Product knowledge
- Specific technologies
- Financial Management

We will build **behavioral competency models by job family**

and **technical competencies by position**.

Brighter Strategies
Better process Brighter results

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Job Families

- **Professional Staff**: Entry-level or focused on admin and support regardless of years of experience.
- **People Managers:** Minimum of 4+ years of experience, responsible for own work and that of others, directly or indirectly. Manages and is accountable for a project or organizational process and team members' performance and development.
- **Senior Management**: Leads a business unit or function for the organization, sets strategy for their area, and contributes to the organizational strategy. Responsible for the overall success of the organization.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS

Connect • Serve • Change Lives

CORE COMPETENCIES

WORK FOCUS	Interpersonal Communication	Team Communication	Conflict Management
WORK APPROACH	Adaptability/Resilience	Managing Change	Organizational Change
PEOPLE FOCUS	Teamwork	Team Leadership	Strategic Leadership
PEOPLE APPROACH	Collaboration	Action Oriented	Creativity & Innovation
UNIVERSAL MANAGERS		Coaching/Mentoring	
		Delegating Responsibility	
UNIVERSAL ALL	Building Trust		
	Problem Solving/ Decision Making		
	Cultural Competence		
	Accountability		
	Technical & Professional Knowledge & Skill		
	Professional Staff	People Managers	Senior Management

Accountability

Professional Staff	People Managers	Senior Management
1. Acts with a clear sense of ownership. 2. Completes work in a timely manner; is communicative and collaborative, follows through on commitments. 3. Communicates when a task cannot be accomplished on time. 4. Delivers good results for all assigned tasks and goals. 5. Accepts full responsibility for self and contribution as a team member; displays honesty and truthfulness.	1. Follows through on commitments and leads by example to ensure others do the same. 2. Effectively manages up by appropriately delegating responsibilities and tasks, checks in frequently with staff and direct reports; avoids micromanaging. 3. Establishes clear responsibilities and processes for monitoring work and measuring results.	1. Establishes expectations and acts as a role model for the standards of excellence. 2. Sets an example for leadership and staff behavior. 3. Models' personal responsibility for decisions, actions, and failures.

Cultural Competence

Professional Staff

1. Examines own biases and behaviors to avoid stereotypical actions or responses.
2. Understands that microaggressions and biases do exist, manages oneself to remain mindful of different worldviews.
3. Sees diversity as an opportunity, challenges bias and intolerance.
4. Has a willingness to be open to others, to accept and respect cultural differences and to learn from others.

People Managers

1. Has the capacity to conduct self-assessment, manage differences, acquire and institutionalize cultural knowledge and adapt to diversity.
2. Remains culturally aware and promotes an environment where everyone belongs and where diversity is embraced.
3. Demonstrates and reinforces behaviors, attitudes, policies, and structures enabling others to work cross-culturally effectively.
4. Coaches others when necessary to achieve desired cultural outcomes.

Senior Management

1. Views diversity as an opportunity for the organization to improve, grow, and expand.
2. Encourages perspective-taking and inclusion; actively finds ways to engage multiple perspectives.
3. Implements and promotes processes, policies, and structures that are equitable and adaptable for cultural needs.
4. Builds a diverse and inclusive organization able to operate globally and leverage cultural differences for innovation.

Problem Solving /Decision Making

Professional Staff
Problem Solving

1. Considers feedback while problem-solving or implementing a decision-making process.
2. Applies a logical method for organizing and analyzing information.
3. Informs manager, supervisor, or team leader of important issues or problems.
4. Takes action or generates alternative solutions to resolve problems or situations.

People Managers
Problem Solving & Decision Making

1. Approaches a complex task or problem by breaking it down into parts and considers each part in detail.
2. Constantly develops informed, timely and effective decisions, distinguishing between relevant and irrelevant information, and consulting others, when appropriate.
3. Examines internal and external conditions to inform decision-making.
4. Gathers sound, fact-based conclusions, particularly when under pressure or faced with ambiguity.

Senior Management
Decision Making

1. Makes informed and timely decisions while considering the strategic, financial, and operational organizational impacts of the decision being made.
2. Anticipates the consequences of decisions.
3. Considers the long-term impacts of strategic decisions and choices that will impact the organization.
4. Considers multiple factors (e.g., customers' needs, feasibility, deadlines, costs, etc.) when making decisions.
5. Guides the setting of specific and measurable organizational goals and objectives.
6. Generates solutions, taking into consideration political, organizational, and individual realities.
7. Is explicit about which decision-making mode is appropriate for a situation.

Building Trust

Professional Staff

1. Shares all information completely and accurately.
2. Behaves and expresses oneself openly and honestly.
3. Completes almost all assignments on time; informs others when a delay will occur.
4. Demonstrates organizational values in daily activities and behaviors.
5. Adheres to all policies and procedures.
6. Places confidence in colleagues and management.

People Managers

1. Is consistent in all cases with what he or she says and does.
2. Appropriately handles difficult situations.
3. Consistently, in all cases, shares information that is accurate and complete.
4. Handles sensitive information appropriately, does not share confidential information.
5. Shows genuine interest in the success of others and promotes and showcases their abilities.
6. Places confidence in colleagues, staff members, leadership and clients.
7. Instills a climate of trust by admitting mistakes and taking responsibility for one's actions.

Senior Management

1. Is a role model for consistently, in all cases, sharing accurate and complete information and handling sensitive data with extreme care; encourages and inspires others to act the same.
2. Builds trust through accountability, effective delegation, and collaborative efforts.
3. Demonstrates and models the organizational values in daily activities and behaviors.
4. Instills a climate of trust by admitting mistakes, taking responsibility for one's actions, and ensuring teams do the same.
5. Allows people to learn from mistakes and thereby encourages new, innovative thinking.
6. Demonstrates commitment to POA's goals, initiatives, policies and procedures through communication and actions.
7. Fosters and promotes an inclusive environment for all employees.

Delegating Responsibility

Professional Staff	People Managers	Senior Management
1. Delegates assignments to the appropriate individuals based on their skills, roles, and interests	1. Delegates authority and responsibility to staff members and holds them accountable for their actions. 2. Clearly defines and communicates objectives and tasks. 3. Communicates context, purpose, and long-term benefits to empower others to take greater responsibility. 4. Communicates expectations regarding outcomes or deliverables, timelines, and quality of work. 5. Clearly communicates the parameters of the delegated responsibility, including decision-making authority and any required actions, constraints or deadlines. 6. Delegates responsibility and authority to others based on their ability and potential. 7. Thoughtfully and strategically allocates decision-making authority and/or task responsibility in appropriate areas to the appropriate individuals.	1. Assesses the entire organization, delegates tasks and responsibilities with the aim to distribute power, develop others and build redundancy and resilience. 2. Provides others with opportunities that challenge them and develop their capabilities. 3. Divides overall work into components and determines what can be delegated. 4. Identifies and demonstrates supportive coaching behavior. 5. Suggests resources and provides assistance or coaching, as needed; expresses confidence and trust in the individual. 6. Stays informed and establishes appropriate procedures to keep informed of issues and results in areas of shared responsibility.

Coaching/Mentoring

Professional Staff	People Managers	Senior Management
	1. Successfully supports staff members' needs by creating opportunities to help others develop skills and expand knowledge; encouraging questions to ensure understanding. 2. Considers individual differences and talents in supporting professional development. 3. Employs and encourages a feedback process for self and others; recognizes performance excellence. 4. Establishes clear expectations and goals and ensures team or staff members adopt key elements. 5. Gives timely, appropriate, and objective feedback on tasks/activities; reinforces efforts and supports development. 6. Adapts guidance and style based on individual needs. 7. Identifies effective strategies for modifying behaviors and attitudes. 8. Shares expertise and provides informal advice.	1. Creates opportunities for growth and development, assures that failure is acceptable, demonstrates empathy, and provides continuous feedback, encouraging leadership to do the same. 2. Facilitates a culture of learning and trust; acts as a role model and example to others. 3. Is committed to the development of their team and the organization. Develops future leaders; creates and implements succession plans. 4. Encourages and facilitates leadership development opportunities for staff at all levels in the organization. 5. Encourages staff creativity and innovation; is patient and curates a safe space for mistakes and growth, and development. Empowers staff in their job roles.

People Approach

Professional Staff
Collaboration

1. Coordinates efforts with other relevant staff to ensure awareness, shares information, and provides updates until completion.
2. Communicates clearly, actively listens to others, takes responsibility for mistakes, and respects the diversity of colleagues.
3. Proactively tries to build effective working relationships with other people.
4. Works with others to share information and achieve goals.
5. Seeks and expands on original ideas, enhances others' ideas, and contributes own ideas about the issues at hand.
6. Resolves conflicts, confrontations and disagreements positively and constructively.

People Managers
Action-Oriented

1. Sets challenging performance standards for self and team.
2. Tackles problems or conflicts head-on; doesn't procrastinate.
3. Takes the initiative to identify and solve work-related problems.
4. Values planning, but will take quick, decisive action when an opportunity presents itself.
5. Works with vigor, effectiveness, and determination over a sustained period, and encourages teams and staff members to do the same.
6. Works towards goals that benefit the team, which includes contributing ideas and participating in team activities appropriately.
7. Facilitates agreement by resolving differences of opinion when necessary.

Senior Management
Creativity & Innovation

1. Fosters and models an organizational work culture that encourages creative thinking and innovation.
2. Suggests or proposes alternative ways to view or define problems; is not constrained by conventional thinking and established approaches
3. Understands and effectively manages the creative process of others; facilitates effective brainstorming.
4. Assesses, manages and takes calculated risks to achieve goals.
5. Mentors staff to combine ideas in unique ways or makes connections between disparate ideas.

People Focus

Professional Staff
Teamwork

1. Supports team decisions, is a good team player, does their share of the work.
2. Keeps other team members informed and up to date about what is happening in the group. Shares all relevant or useful information.
3. Acquires information and skills necessary to contribute to team goals.
4. Works cooperatively with other team members, involves others, shares information as appropriate, and shares credit for team accomplishments.
5. Listens to constructive feedback and incorporates suggestions to achieve collective objectives.
6. Participates willingly and effectively on team assignments and projects.
7. Solicits input from team members.

People Managers
Team Leadership

1. Leads team in a way that supports team members in embodying the organization's vision, mission, and values.
2. Communicates expectations regarding outcomes or deliverables, timelines, and quality of work.
3. Provides ongoing support of processes and systems that identify, capture, distribute, and reuse knowledge.
4. Solicits input from team members.
5. Makes procedural or process suggestions for achieving team goals or performing team functions; provides necessary resources or helps to remove obstacles to team accomplishments.
6. Helps to clarify roles and responsibilities of team members; clearly defines and communicates objectives and tasks.

Senior Management
Strategic Leadership

1. Models excellent leadership behavior and incorporates participatory and inclusive leadership principles into their work.
2. Displays adaptive leadership, listens and responds to the input of others, and accepts feedback from staff members and different teams within the organization.
3. Canvases strategic opportunities for business growth and change.
4. Capitalizes on opportunities and manages risks.
5. Demonstrates awareness of the whole system and how areas integrate.
6. Displays awareness of impact of external factors on organizational operation.

Work Approach

Professional Staff

Adaptability/Resilience

1. Acknowledges when adjustments to timelines, results, and expectations need to be changed and appropriately acts upon new information.
2. Overcomes obstacles to achieve results.
3. Acknowledges new information and adjusts responses accordingly.
4. Adjusts timelines, results and expectations appropriately to changing needs.
5. Persists towards solutions and goals in changing circumstances.
6. Quickly modifies behavior to deal effectively with changes in the work environment; readily tries new approaches appropriate for new or changed situations; does not persist with ineffective behaviors.

People Managers

Managing Change

1. Understands and explains the origin and reasoning behind key policies, practices, and procedures when implementing or managing changes.
2. Manages through complexities, contradictions, and paradoxes or reduces their impact; clarifies direction and eases the change process.
3. Comfortably handles risk and uncertainty in a way that motivates and encourages staff to do the same.
4. Focuses on the long-term good of the change, not short-term inconveniences, encourages and inspires staff to do the same.

Senior Management

Organizational Change

1. Supports the organization in adjusting activities based on results and feedback and is responsible for driving change processes where needed.
2. Displays leadership in a way that enables the organization to adapt to a changing environment.
3. Is a role model and shows personal commitment to the change. Remains focused on what is best for the entire organization.
4. Inspires and motivates leadership and staff when faced with unprecedented change; clearly explains the reasons for change and the path forward.
5. Listens attentively to everyone’s ideas and concerns and drives change processes through action, motivation, and leadership.

Work Focus

Professional Staff

Interpersonal Communication

1. Actively asks relevant questions.
2. Clearly and effectively conveys information.
3. Organizes, expresses, and communicates ideas clearly.
4. Communicates effectively with individuals from a variety of cultural backgrounds.
5. Communicates ideas clearly and effectively in a group setting.
6. Listens attentively; asks clarifying questions and summarizes or paraphrases what others have said to verify understanding.

People Managers

Team Communication

1. Facilitates small and larger meetings so that all staff members and teams feel included and motivated.
2. Develops project plans, specifications, outlines, and/or progress reports and uses these tools to keep the team organized and communication streamlined.
3. Conveys information clearly and concisely. Provides clear instructions or information to peers/staff members/teams to ensure focus on priorities.
4. Ensures that regular communication occurs based on the needs of the work, the individual, management or the situation.

Senior Management

Conflict Management

1. Keeps staff accountable for fostering an organizational-wide culture that positively manages conflict.
2. Objectively views the conflict from all sides.
3. Views conflict as a team issue, demonstrates conflict as an opportunity to build productive relationships.
4. Takes positive action to resolve the conflict in a way that addresses the issue, dissipates the conflict, and maintains the relationship.
5. Does not hesitate to put issues on the table to be discussed.
6. Can recognize successful and constructive conflict management and then reward it.

Competencies by Job Family

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Universal – Every member of the workforce

- **Accountability:** Holds self and others accountable for measurable high-quality, timely, cost-effective results. Determines objectives, sets priorities, and delegates work. Accepts responsibility for mistakes. Complies with established control systems and rules.
- **Building Trust:** Interacts with others in a way that gives them confidence in their motives and representations and those of the organization. Is seen as direct and truthful; keeps assurances, promises, and commitments.
- **Cultural Competence:** Cultivates opportunities through diverse people; respects and relates well to people from varied backgrounds; understands various worldviews and is sensitive to group differences; sees diversity as an opportunity; challenges bias and intolerance.
- **Problem-Solving:** Breaks problems into components; recognizes interrelationships; makes sound, well-informed, and objective decisions. Compares data, information, and input from various sources to conclude; takes action consistent with available facts, constraints, and probable consequences.
- **Decision Making:** Makes choices by identifying a decision, gathering information, and assessing alternative resolutions. Takes responsibility for and demonstrates a commitment to making appropriate decisions promptly. Ensures decisions based on policies, rules, and organizational directives and solves emerging problems.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Universal for Managers– People Managers and Executive Leaders

- **Delegating Responsibility:** Allocates decision-making authority and task responsibility to others, as appropriate, to maximize organizational and individual effectiveness.
- **Coaching/Mentoring:** Providing timely guidance and feedback to help others strengthen the knowledge/skills needed to accomplish a task or solve a problem.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Professional Staff

- **Collaboration:** Builds constructive working relationships with clients/customers, other work units, community organizations, and others to meet mutual goals and objectives; behaves professionally and supportively when working with individuals from various ethnic, social, and educational backgrounds.
- **Teamwork:** Participates as an active and contributing team member to achieve team goals. Works cooperatively with other team members, involves others, shares information as appropriate, and shares credit for team accomplishments.
- **Adaptability/Resilience*:*** Adapts well to adversity and changes in assignments and priorities; adapts behavior or work methods in response to new information, changing conditions, or unexpected obstacles; approaches change positively and adjusts behaviors accordingly. Effectively adapts to difficult, unpredictable situations.
- **Interpersonal Communication:** Conveys and receives information and ideas through various media to individuals or groups in a manner that engages the listener, helps them understand and retain the message, and invites response and feedback. Keeps others informed appropriately; demonstrates good written, oral, and listening skills.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

People Managers

- **Action Oriented:** Consistently maintains high levels of activity or productivity; sustains long working hours when necessary; works with vigor, effectiveness, and determination over a sustained period.
- **Team Leadership:** Communicates a vision and inspires motivation; engages with others (direct-reports and peers) in team process to solve problems; works to find a win/win resolution of differences; is aware of how management style impacts staff productivity and development; modifies leadership style to meet situational requirements; helps the team stay focused on significant goals while managing within a context of multiple directives.
- **Managing Change:** Facilitates the implementation and acceptance of change within the workplace; encourages others to seek opportunities for different and innovative approaches to addressing problems and opportunities.
- **Team Communication:** Inspires and fosters team commitment; facilitates cooperation and motivates team members to accomplish group goals; promotes cohesiveness of a team by defining roles and responsibilities of each team member and establishes overall objectives, including the entire team in the decision-making process; leads team to create systems and processes that facilitate the team's work; addresses dysfunctional team behaviors and actively work to resolve issues.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Senior Management

- **Creativity & Innovation:** Anticipates and continually seeks ways to develop and improve for the organization and professionally as an individual, including staying current with tools, trends, and techniques. In senior roles, proactively finds opportunities for business growth and improvement.
- **Strategic Leadership:** Expresses a strategic vision for the organization; ability to motivate and persuade others to acquire that vision.
- **Organizational Change:** Supports the organization in adjusting activities based on results and feedback and takes responsibility for driving change processes where needed. Advances the organization's success with ongoing change, and effectively manages the change process within the organization. Enables the organization to adapt to a changing environment.
- **Conflict Management:** Uses appropriate interpersonal styles and techniques to reduce tension and conflict between two or more people; able to size up situations quickly; identify common interests; facilitates resolution.

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies

Thank You

www.brighterstrategies.com

Brighter Strategies
Better process Brighter results

Copyright 2023: Brighter Strategies